



Meltdown & Shutdown Recovery Plan

Pre-plan for during and after meltdowns/shutdowns

CBT & Emotional Regulation

Ages 8–adult

2026 Clinical Guideline: This worksheet reflects updated 2026 best practices: strengths-based framing, individual autonomy, sensory-informed design, and co-regulation strategies. Adapt to the individual's communication style and preferences.

Personal Information

NAME

DATE

THERAPIST / PARENT

Activity



BEFORE

My early warning signs

What usually triggers me

Who to tell



DURING

Where is my safe space

What I need (no demands)

What helps me calm down



AFTER

How to recover

Who can debrief with me

What to do next time

Notes & Reflections

WHAT WORKED WELL TODAY

Write or draw...

WHAT TO TRY DIFFERENTLY NEXT TIME

Write or draw...